

How to build a High Carb *Meal.*

Protein, vegetables, healthy fats and a generous portion of carbohydrate.

When building a high carb meal there will be a *focus on*:

- A portion of protein (tofu, egg, fish etc), whether it is meat or plant protein
- A portion of vegetables or salad
- Some healthy fats such as extra virgin olive oil, avocado, seeds, flaxseed, sunflower seeds or walnuts
- A higher amount of additional carbohydrates, such as more than a few tablespoons of grain, 2 slices of bread, a large wrap, more than 3 tbsps legumes

This can be built in 3 ways:

1. Adding only a complex carb
2. Adding a complex carb and a legume
3. Adding only a legume

Option 1: When adding only a complex carb (pasta, rice bread etc.) this will make up roughly 1/4 of the plate.

This will *look like this*:

How To Build A High Carb Meal



- **Step 1:** Fill 1/2 of your plate with vegetables and fruits
- **Step 2:** Fill 1/4 of your plate with complex carbohydrates
- **Step 3:** Fill 1/4 of your plate with lean protein
- **Step 4:** Add a small portion of healthy fats

Option 2: When including a carbohydrate/protein food like legumes or falafel in a high carbohydrate meal, the additional carbohydrate (i.e. pasta, rice etc.) will need to be reduced, as the carbohydrate/protein food will count towards the carbohydrate element.

This will *look like this*:

High Carbohydrate Meals With A Carbohydrate/Protein Element

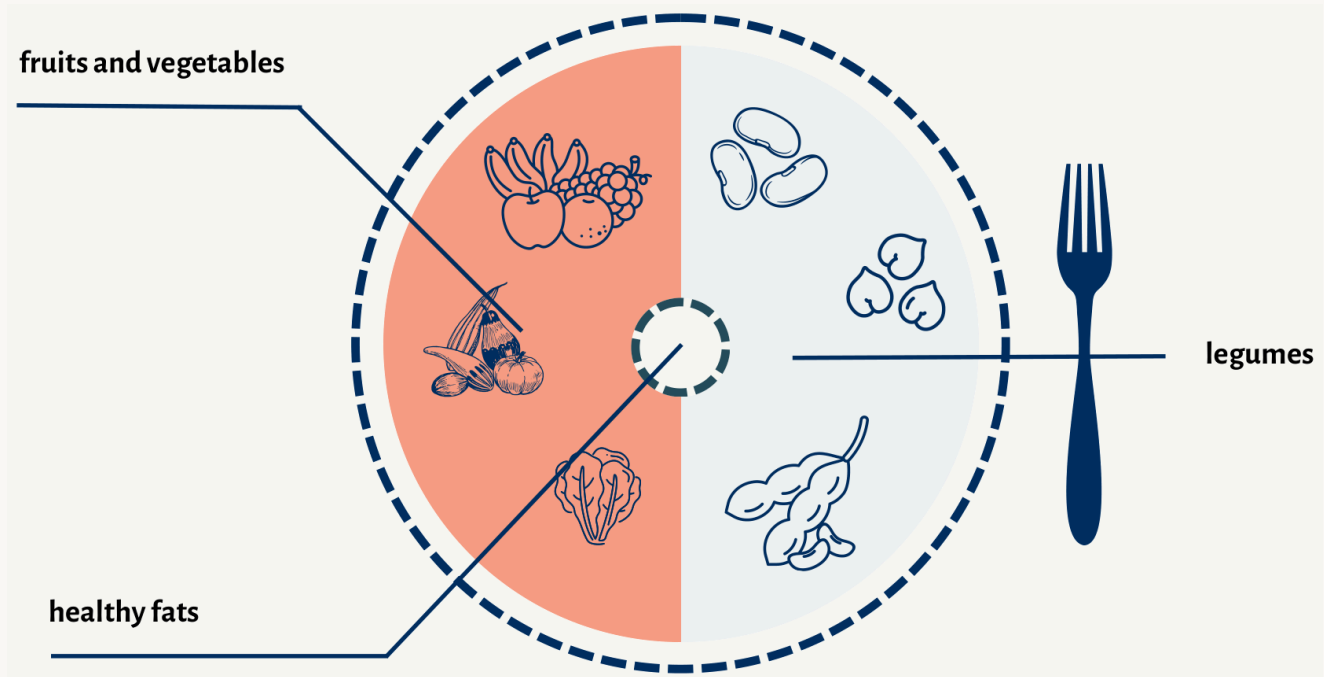


- **STEP 1:** Fill 1/2 of your plate with vegetables and fruits
- **STEP 2:** Fill 1/3 of your plate with legumes [i.e. chickpeas, beans etc. (3 tbsp) or falafel (2-3 pieces)]
- **STEP 3:** Fill 1/6 of your plate with complex carbohydrates
- **STEP 4:** Add a small portion of healthy fats

Option 3: A high carbohydrate meal could also be made up of only the legumes without the additional carbohydrate element (i.e. 6 TBSP legumes OR 5-6 falafels).

This will *look like this*:

High Carbohydrate Meals With Only A Carbohydrate/Protein Element



- **Step 1:** Fill 1/2 of your plate with vegetables and fruits
- **Step 2:** Fill 1/2 of your plate with legumes [i.e. chickpeas, beans etc. (6 tbsp) or falafels (5-6 pieces)]
- **Step 3:** Add a small portion of healthy fats

To *prepare* your meal:

- Select one protein
- Select a vegetable or fruit option
- Select a carbohydrate
- Select a healthy fat

Select Your Protein	Select Your Veg/Fruit	Select Your Carbohydrate	Add A Healthy Fat
Cooked Meats (Beef, Pork, Chicken etc.)	Side Salad	Wholemeal Pasta (>40g)	Olive Oil
Canned Fish (Tuna, Salmon, Mackerel)	Steamed Veg	Wholegrain Rice (>40g)	Nuts
Sausages or Mince	Stir Fry Veg	Potatoes (>100g)	Seeds
Falafels *	Roasted Veg	Sweet Potatoes (>100g)	Nut Butter
Beans or chickpeas *		Couscous (>40g)	Avocado
Cheese or Dairy (Halloumi, Feta)		Wholemeal Bread (2 slices)	Greek Yoghurt
Vegetarian Alternatives (Tofu, Tempeh, Quorn)		Noodles (>40g)	Vegetarian Alternatives (Tofu, Tempeh, Quorn)
Breaded fish, fish cake, chicken goujons etc *		Quinoa (>40g)	

Depending on the quantity adding a carb element may not be applicable or need to be reduced to the medium carb portion.

Some *examples of high carb meals* include:

LUNCH OR DINNER

Soup With Protein and 2 slices of bread

Meat (Chicken, Beef, Fish, Veggie Alternative) With Salad and a larger portion of potatoes/sweet potatoes etc. (approx. 1/4 of the plate)

Meat (Chicken, Fish, Veggie Alternative) With Veggies (Steamed, Roasted, Stir-Fry) and a large portion of rice/pasta/noodles/quinoa etc. (approx. 1/4 of the plate)

Falafel (6 falafel) with Salad or Veggies

Any beans/chickpeas (3 tbsp) With Salad or Veggies and a smaller portion of rice/pasta/noodles/quinoa etc. (30-40g)

Within the 12-week meal plans (winter and summer) the high carb meals are labelled as HC